AdamsBrain M1, Phase 1: Walking Skeleton

The first real code. Goal: a deployed page on the internet that reads a real row from Postgres. Sessions 8 to 14, ~4/week from Mon 22 Sep. Dates are estimates: the plan is weekly, not daily, so a slipped day is not "behind."

Phase done when: a public Vercel URL loads a page that reads a STUDENT row from a Postgres database. **Standing rules:** every deliverable is a branch + PR, no direct commits to main. Generated code does not merge until you explain it back and answer one question. **[YOU]** = you write it by hand; **[GEN]** = I generate it.

Session	Est. date	Focus	#	Deliverable	Done
8	Mon 22 Sep	**Scaffold**	**1**	[GEN] Next.js App Router + TypeScript + Tailwind project created, runs at localhost:3000	[ ]
			2	Design tokens ported into tailwind.config.ts using extend (from design-tokens.md)	[ ]
			3	Explain-back: what the App Router is, what app/layout.tsx does, what "use client" means	[ ]
9	Tue 23 Sep	**Deploy**	**4**	Repo connected to Vercel, first deployment, real public URL exists	[ ]
			5	Understand preview deploys (per PR) vs production (main). Push a branch, see its preview	[ ]
			6	One env var set in the Vercel dashboard and read in code. No secrets in the repo	[ ]
10	Thu 25 Sep	**Database**	**7**	Postgres instance created on Neon or Supabase (verify current free-tier limits yourself)	[ ]
			8	[GEN] Prisma installed and connected. Explain-back: what an ORM is, what schema.prisma is	[ ]
			9	[YOU] First schema from the ERD: the STUDENT table only (username, password_hash, must_change_password). Start small	[ ]
11	Sat 27 Sep	**Migration**	**10**	[YOU] First migration run. Explain-back: what a migration is, why they are version-controlled	[ ]
			11	[GEN] Seed script (prisma db seed) creates 2 students: assigned usernames, hashed temporary passwords	[ ]
			12	Deployed app connected to the database via a pooled connection string (env var)	[ ]
12	Mon 29 Sep	**First route (the key session)**	**13**	[YOU] One API route: given a username, read that Student from Postgres, return JSON. Never include password_hash	[ ]
			14	[YOU] Handle the error case: unknown username returns a proper 404, not a crash	[ ]
			15	[YOU] A page fetches the route and shows the student. Skeleton walks end to end. ~15 lines	[ ]
13	Tue 30 Sep	**Harden**	**16**	Explain-back on everything merged (request/response lifecycle, HTTP status codes, async/await)	[ ]
			17	[YOU] Input validation: empty, garbage, and over-long input all handled	[ ]
			18	Fix whatever the explain-back exposed	[ ]
14	Thu 2 Oct	**Float**	**19**	Catch up on any slipped session, or read the Phase 2 system-design doc I will write (auth)	[ ]
			20	Phase review: send the ticked table + one honest line on whether the pace held	[ ]

Why this order. The walking skeleton is deliberately thin: it does almost nothing but proves every layer connects (browser -> Vercel -> API route -> Prisma -> Postgres). Building it now surfaces integration problems while they are still cheap. Auth, the tutor, and persistence all sit on top of this in later phases.

Session 12 is the one that matters. It is about 15 lines of code and you should understand every one. If it takes 40 minutes you skipped the point; take the whole block. **Call me immediately if:** stuck 90+ min, tempted to copy code you do not understand, or two sessions pass with nothing ticked.